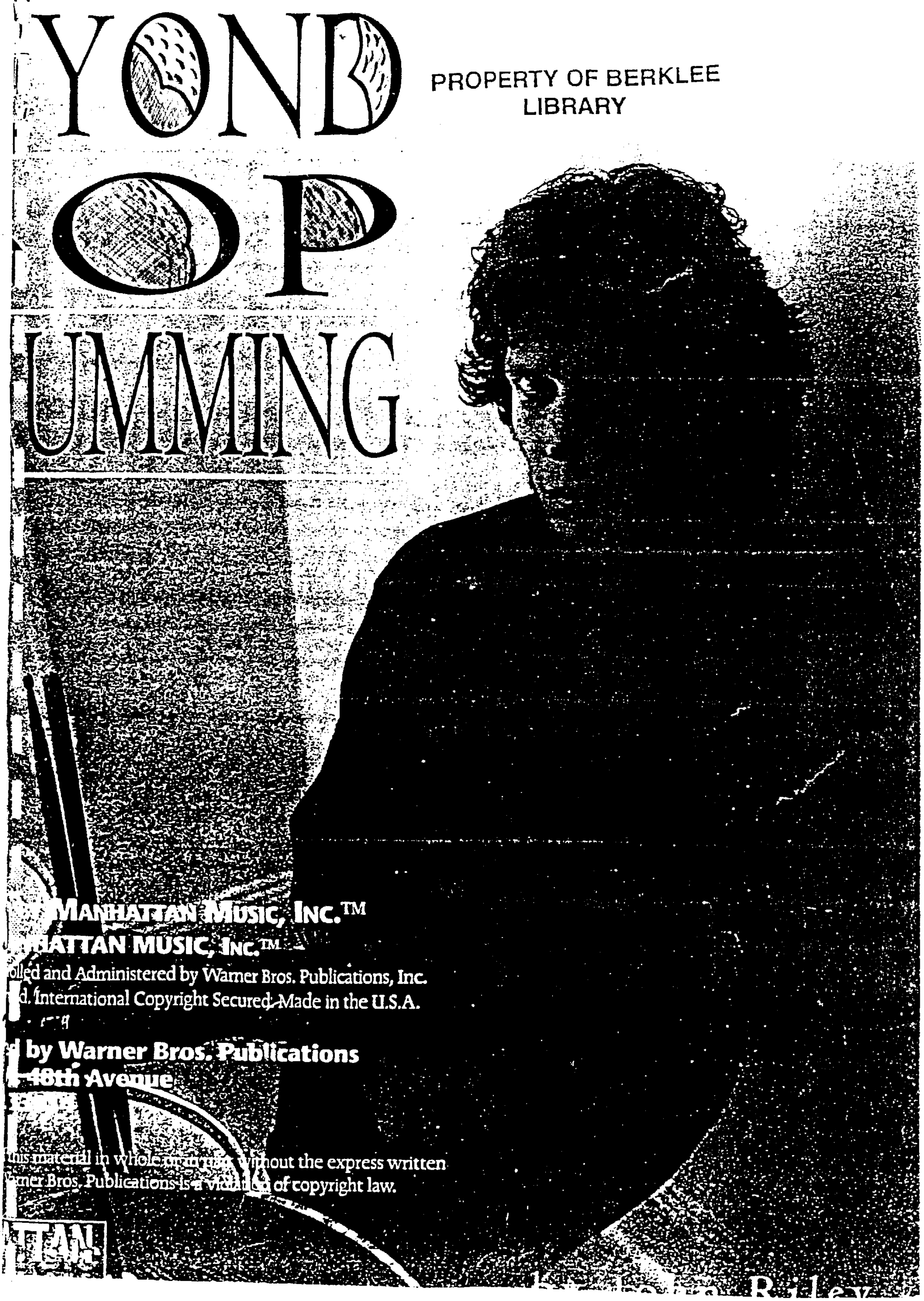
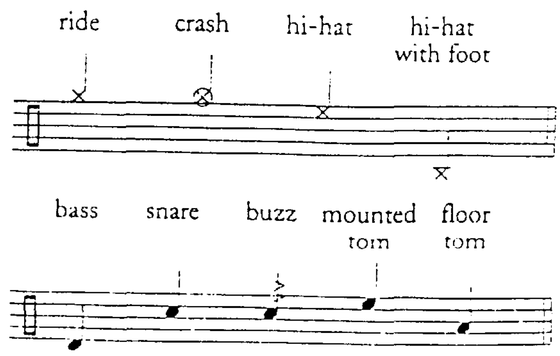

YOND
OP
UMMING
MANHATTAN MUSIC, INC.™
HATTAN MUSIC, INC.™
olled and Administered by Warner Bros. Publications, Inc.
d. International Copyright Secured. Made in the U.S.A.
by Warner Bros. Publications
48th Avenue
this material in whole or in part without the express written
rner Bros. Publications is a violation of copyright law.
TTAN
Riley

Contents

Key



4 Three-voice Warm-ups
5 Three-voice Comping in 8th-notes (slow)
6 Three-voice Comping in 8th-notes (fast)
7 "Picture 3" Comping
8 Warm-ups for Three-voice Comping in Triplets
9 Orchestrated Three-voice Comping
10 Three-voice Comping in Triplets (slow)
11 Three-voice Comping in Triplets (fast)
12 Ride Cymbal Variation 1
13 Ride Cymbal Variation 2
14 Quarter-notes with the Hi-hat
15 "All or Nothing at All" Comping
16 "The El Trane" (slow version)

Uptempo Studies

17 Uptempo Exercise with Bass
18 Bass track for play-along
19 Uptempo Ride Cymbal Variations
20 "Blind Faith"

Implied Time/Metric Modulation

21 Implying 6 over 4
22 Implying 3/4 over 4/4
23 Implying 2 over 3 in 4/4
24 Implying 4 over 3 in 4/4
25 Implying 4/4 over 3/4
26 Implying 4 over 3 in 3/4
27 Implying 9 over 6 in 3/4
28 Five-note Phrases
29 "The El Trane" (fast version)

Solo Ideas

30 Three-beat Phrases
31 The Variable Speed Phrase
32 Triplets in Groups of 4
33 Eight-bar Combination Phrases
34 "Monk's Dream" Variations
35 "In the Fall" Variations
36 "Agitation" Variations
37 Cross-sticking Variations
38 "Speed Bumps Ahead"
42 "Speed Bumps Ahead" Drum solo section
43 "Blind Faith"
44 "Blind Faith" Drum solo section

Musicians:

Tim Ries	**tenor and soprano saxophone**
Jim McNeely	**piano**
Jay Anderson	**bass**
John Riley	**drums**

Recorded October 17–18, 1996
Park West Recording Brooklyn, NY
Engineered by Jim Clouse
Mastered by Frank Pekoc at
Joe Lopes Music Mastering, L.I.C., NY
Produced by John Riley and Dan Thress

All compositions by John Riley

Drums:
GMS, 14x20 bd, 8x12, 14x14, 5x14 sd

Cymbals:
22" Zildjian K custom medium with two rivets,
18" Zildjian pre-aged K, 13" Zildjian K hi-hats

Sticks:
Zildjian Concert Jazz model

Heads:
Remo Fiberskyn 3

Corresponding music examples are shaded in grey throughout the book

Tracking numbers are listed throughout the book with this icon.

Introduction:

Elvin, Tony, Jack… Whoa!! What's this all about?

My previous book, *The Art of Bop Drumming*, is a primer on good musicianship at the drumset. This book will expand those ideas and explore the innovations of the fertile 1960s musical environment and beyond.

Drummers Elvin Jones, Paul Motian, Ed Blackwell, Tony Williams and Jack DeJohnette, each members of ground-breaking bands, changed the sound, shape and feeling of music. Their playing elevated the position of the drummer to that of the leader of the rhythm section and the emotional energy center of the band. At times, they boldly directed the musical flow as if they were co-soloists in the ensemble. Without the musical contributions of these men, we would not hear or play music the way we do today. Their playing, rooted in the already considerably sophisticated be-bop conventions, continues to project the future of drumming. All of today's leading players have been greatly influenced by, and continue to draw inspiration from, these musical innovators. This is the jazz music that first captivated and excited me, and I offer this book as a tribute to all of the musicians cited within, for they represent, to me, the apex of creative music in the 20th century.

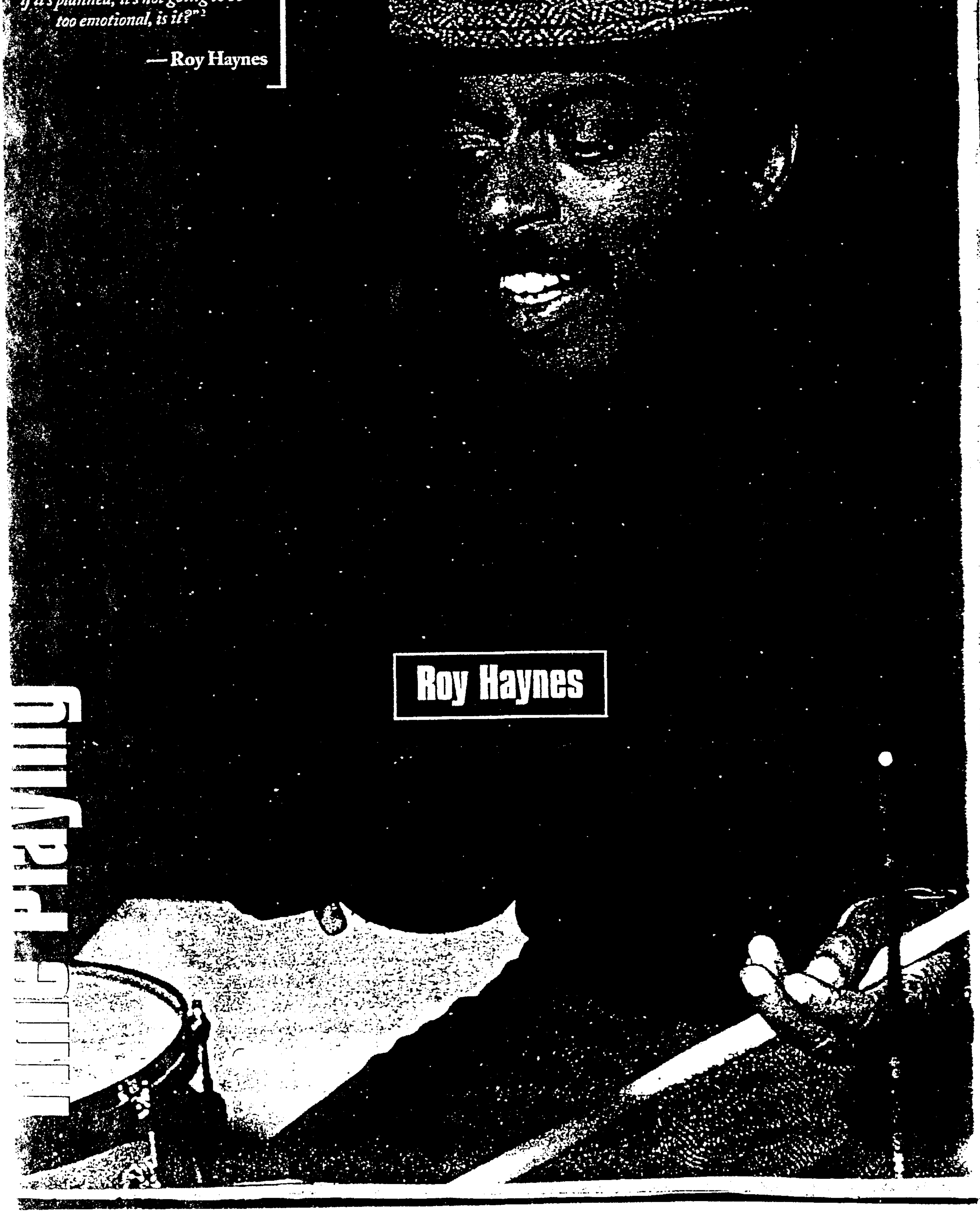
"Beyond Bop," then, is designed to help open these musical frontiers and expand your musical consciousness. This collection of tried and true ideas will show you the how and why of this new, more assertive drumming which grew out of the be-bop style. My hope is that *The Art of Bop Drumming* and this book will serve as gateways through which future generations of musicians will be introduced to, and challenged and inspired by, the lofty musical standards illustrated herein. This material is going to take some effort to assimilate but it will lead to an increased skill level, vocabulary and understanding of rhythm and music. Open your ears and get busy!

John Riley

> *"If you have a drum set in the room and the postman walks in, he'll sit down and go 'dat, dat, dat, do, do, do, buzz, buzz, buzz, bam, boom, boom.' Anybody can do that and keep a beat. If you're really serious about drumming, don't you think that there's more to it than that? There's a technique that really takes concentration, work, dedication, discipline and time… I've always been a student; I've always been studying, constantly. Learning has always been exciting for me. I'm always learning something."*[1]
>
> — Tony Williams

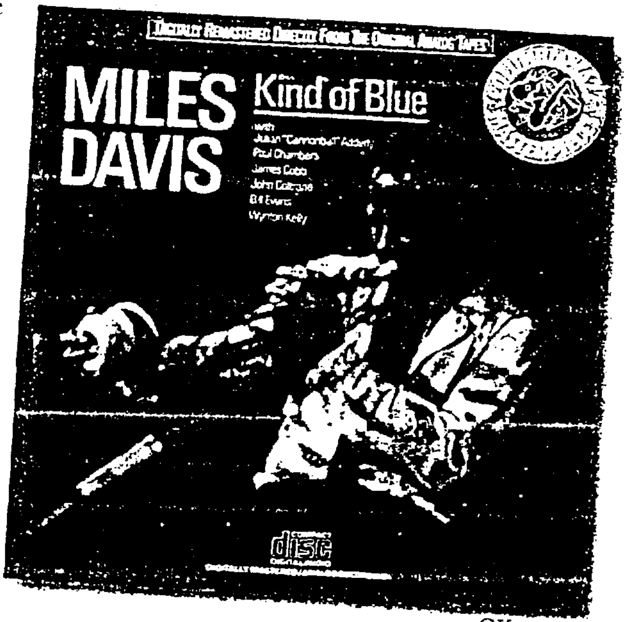
If it's planned, it's not going to be too emotional, is it?"[2]

— Roy Haynes



winds of change were blowing strongly. The fifteen-year run of the be-bop ideal — a soloist playing over complex harmonic cycles with rhythm section accompaniment — was beginning to seem too restrained for some musicians. Those that would lead the way into the next phase were looking for a more "open" format.

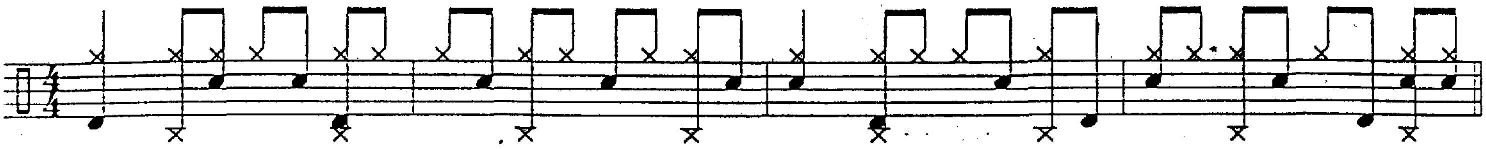
By 1960 most of the key players of the "new thing" were indicating their direction. Saxophonist John Coltrane recorded his ultimate tribute to the harmonic challenges of be-bop, *Giant Steps*, in 1959 and began to investigate looser structures. Miles Davis' influential recording, *Kind of Blue*, also recorded in '59, included Coltrane, pianist Bill Evans and drummer Jimmy Cobb. It was one of the first recordings to explore a more relaxed way of organizing music, incorporating phrases as long as 16 measures in one tonal mode. These longer phrases allowed the rhythm section players and the soloists a natural opportunity for interaction because they all were less encumbered by "the changes." This new musical freedom made the soloists more open to playing off ideas introduced by the rhythm section. At the same time, Ornette Coleman was developing the concept of playing melodic themes followed by collective group improvisation based solely on the mood, spirit, and vocabulary of the melody without any real attachment to a specific key center or even a sense of bar lines. Concurrently, the Bill Evans Trio probed a new notion of playing in which the bass player and drummer became equal participants with Bill in shaping the music. As a result of the introduction of these conceptual changes, and with the increased use of amplification for the other instruments, drummers were being given both greater latitude and a larger responsibility for each ensemble's sound and direction.



CK 40579

To help better understand the "post-bop" concept, let's first take a look at the playing of two accomplished "bop" players who evolved into influential transitional players — Roy Haynes, who's been called "the father of modern drumming" and still sounds fresh today, and Mel Lewis, who has been credited with introducing the important idea of the "open beat." Roy, nicknamed "snap, crackle, pop" because of his sound and phrasing, played mostly in small groups using high-pitched drums and a very crisp sound. Mel, nicknamed "tailor" because of his ability to "make all of the pieces fit," is best known for playing in big bands using low-pitched drums and a loose sound. However, both were among the first to widely exploit the "broken-time feel" which was to become commonplace in the 1960s.

The standard "bop" time feeling is a steady, repetitive ride cymbal pattern with the bass drum underneath and the hi-hat on beats 2 and 4. The accents being played really stand out above the dynamically flat time line. The broken-time feel mixes repetitive with non-repetitive cymbal patterns over "2 and 4" or some varied rhythms on the hi-hat. The bass drum most often follows the cymbal line or plays counterpoint. Snare drum rhythms are woven into the time flow in a smooth fashion. By employing broken-time, these men in essence "told" their band mates that each player in the ensemble was responsible for keeping his own time and, as drummers they weren't going to "baby sit" — playing straight time — at the expense of creating good new music.



Notice that, although the cymbal pattern is irregular, the time still has forward motion because the snare and bass drum parts complete the groove. In this example, Mel's playing clearly demonstrates a concept that was later fully developed by Elvin Jones, Tony Williams and Jack DeJohnette; the drumset should be thought of as *one* instrument, not a collection of separate instruments. The sound and groove are created by ideas played on the entire instrument, not just the ride cymbal and hi-hat. This type of time playing is less insistent than the traditional straight cymbal pattern and gives the music a smoother flow, thus the characterization "open."

Prestige OJCCD-196-2

Now, check out a brief example of Roy Haynes' time playing as heard on *We Three:*

Roy stretches out even further by using the hi-hat effectively as yet another contrapuntal voice.

The work of Roy and Mel continues to be just as inspiring today as it was in the '50s and early '60s. Their conceptual innovations, along with those of many others, helped to set the stage for the dynamic musical changes we're about to explore.

As the '60s began, band leaders were asking for and expecting more from their drummers; the music's slower-moving harmonic rhythm created a fresh environment and presented opportunities for collective interaction that had been inconceivable just a few years earlier. As a result, drummers had to become both more complete and more imaginative as musicians because, over and above all their traditional functions, they now found themselves with the substantial, additional responsibility of creating new sonic milieus for the new music to work.

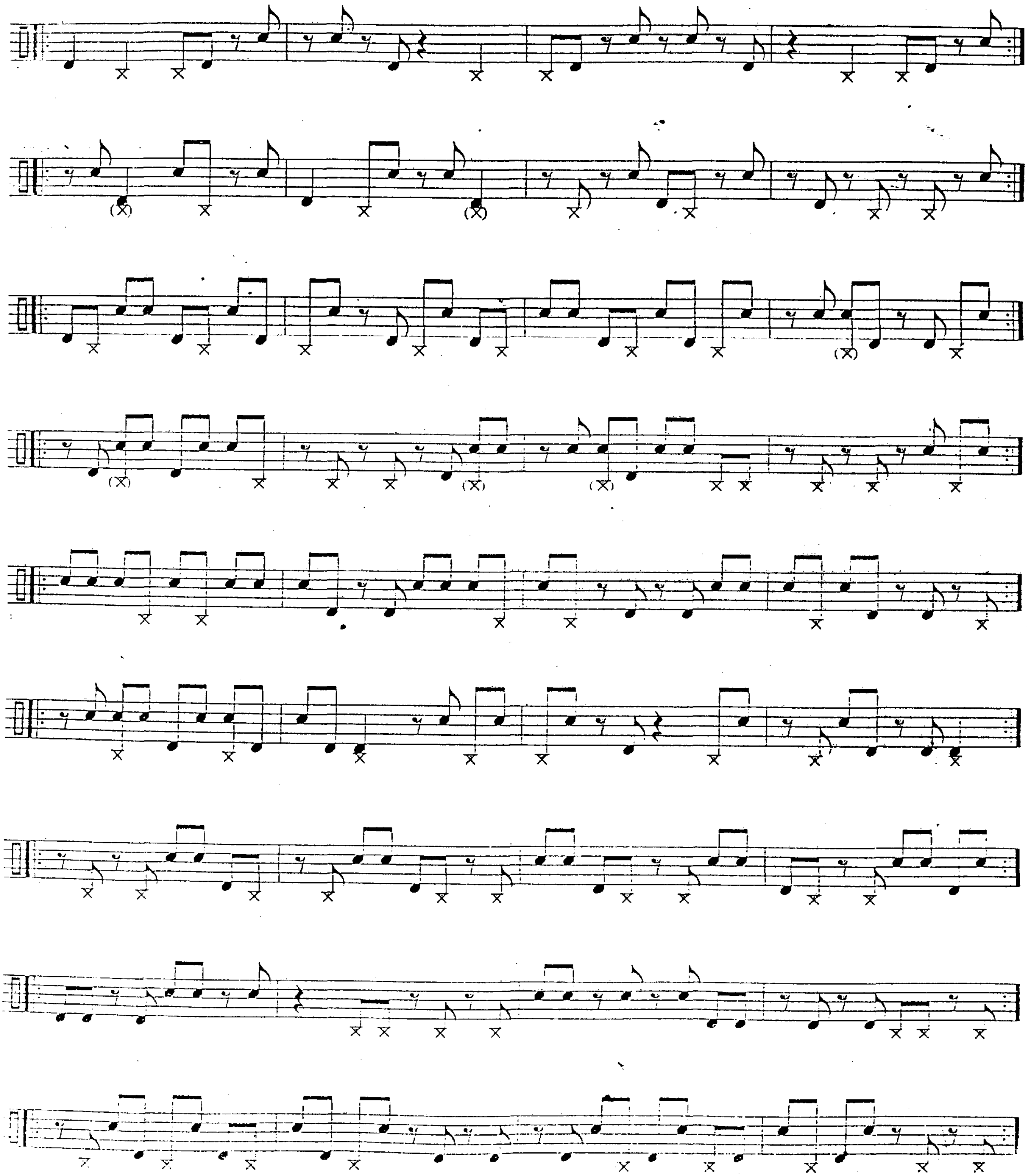
> *"It is one instrument, and I would hasten to say that I take that single idea as the basis for my whole approach to the drums."*[3]
>
> — Elvin Jones

Here are some warm-up exercises, in 8th-notes, that incorporate three moving voices. In addition to practicing Mel's and Roy's examples, using these warm-ups will help you develop a more open and interesting rhythmic flow. It's important that, for now, you don't vary your ride cymbal pattern.

At times, ideas like these can be clearly heard in the playing of Tony Williams and Jack DeJohnette. Remember, this material is quite challenging and will take some time to get together. Also, while you are developing these tools and expanding your vocabulary, there will be a great temptation to play this densely all the time just to "test your wings." This material is really special and must be used sparingly and with good taste or else it will come across as too self-indulgent and no one will enjoy listening to you or playing with you.

Everyone who employs complex ideas like these has obviously done a lot of practicing. You've heard Thomas Edison saying that "genius" is "1% inspiration — 99% perspiration." I believe that this same concept applies to music, and the only real "gift" that a person needs in order to become a player is the ability to spend many productive hours in the practice room and on the bandstand.

As with the warm-ups above, practicing the following three-voice comping exercises will help eliminate "friction" and give you more control of your limbs. Work slowly at first to make sure that your playing is accurate and the moving parts are swinging. Stick with the normal jazz ride cymbal pattern and don't let it accommodate the moving parts until you've completely mastered this material and it's really flowing. These exercises are written in four-measure phrases to help you start to be conscious of longer phrase lengths, but feel free to break them into smaller fragments for practice purposes. Practice these ideas with CD track 39 "The El Trane" (slow version).



with John Abercrombie on the tune "Picture 3" from the record *Pictures* recorded in 1976. This is basically an in time "free" duet — it seems that nothing is predetermined except that both players want to play together. The first 8 measures serve as an intro and set the vibe, then John comes in and off they go.

Notice how melodic Jack's playing is. His individual ideas are not that much different from the bop vocabulary, but the continuous, unbroken flow of ideas and the absence of predictable resolution points are among his trade marks and make his playing sound fresh. Practice this. Again start out slowly and keep the ride cymbal strict. Try to hear a melodic logic in the phrasing.

ECM 1079

There are a number of transcribed excerpts in this book. They are included to show you how specific exercises relate to actual playing, but remember; transcriptions are only a representation of what a particular player did in relation to what other players were doing on a given take. To me, one of the reasons that the "legends" are legendary is that their great playing is continually evolving and being refined. A transcription can't define someone's style; it's merely a moment of music preserved on paper for us to ponder at our own pace. The best source of information and inspiration is listening to a master play live.

> *"Concentrate on what the other instrumentalists are doing. So many drummers just listen to other drummers, but if you don't hear the other parts, you're missing what inspired the drummer to play what he's playing!"*
>
> — Adam Nussbaum

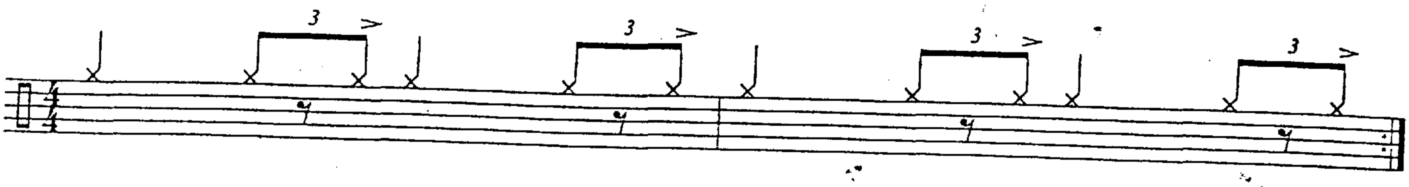
Track

inspiration from. Notice how all the parts work together, creating interesting, challenging and swinging music. Refer to the original recording to hear Jack's sound and feel.

Three-voice Orchestrations

Listen to how much variety you create when you orchestrate some of the warm-up exercises by moving the snare drum parts onto the toms:

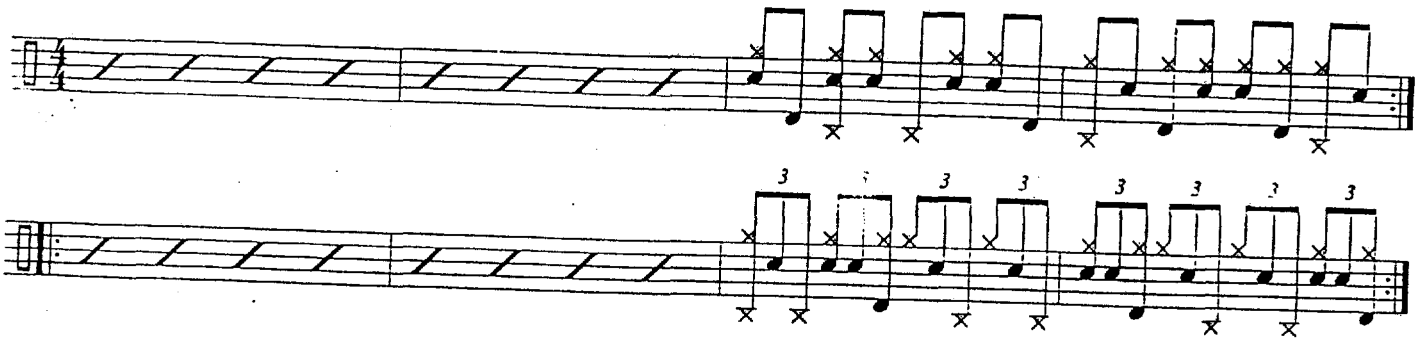
...hen you phrase the cymbal pattern like this:



By accenting the skip note you create a "hump" in the time flow, a la Elvin Jones, that takes some of the drive out of your cymbal beat. The hump creates both a more horizontal time feeling and the "space" necessary to allow the three parts moving under the cymbal line to breathe.

CD 13 Track

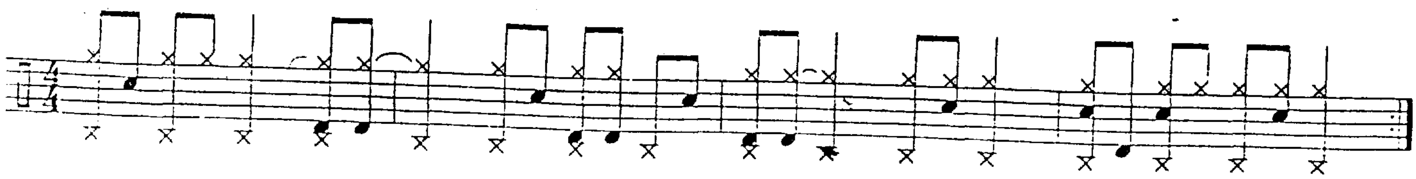
Another way to accommodate all the action going on under the cymbal line is to allow the ride pattern to loosen up and follow the contour of the moving parts.



CD 14 Track

Tony Williams found that by shifting the consistent time flow element, at medium to fast tempos from the ride cymbal to the hi-hat, he could play more freely with the ride cymbal. Tony played quarter-notes, with his foot, on the hi-hat, which allowed him to explore and develop interesting multi-voice ideas between the ride cymbal, snare and bass drum. The example below shows some of the possibilities. Phrasing like this can be developed further by practicing playing quarter-notes with the hi-hat pedal while incorporating the exercises in either G.L. Stone's *Stick Control* book or Ted Reed's *Syncopation.* Play the ride cymbal and bass drum in unison while the snare plays the in-between notes. Or play both hands together while the bass drum fills in the rest of the 8th-notes.

> *"There was an innovation that happened when Tony Williams came on the scene with Miles. He started playing quarter-notes with the high-hat pedal, using that as the focal point of the rhythm."*[5]
>
> — Max Roach



Elvin Jones is the king of triplet phrasing. Check out how he creates his own unique time feel on "All or Nothing At All" from the 1962 John Coltrane recording *Ballads.* After a 30-measure intro, the form is AABA, 16-16-16-16. The A sections have a Latin feel and the bridge is swing. The quartet plays this tune in an abbreviated fashion, as is often done on ballads and "Pop" type tunes. After one time through the head, AABA, they go directly to the bridge, then the last A and a tag. When a leader wants to use this type of treatment he'll say "let's play only a chorus and a half." This transcription is from the first time they play the bridge [1:23 into the track]. Practice using the normal ride pattern first.

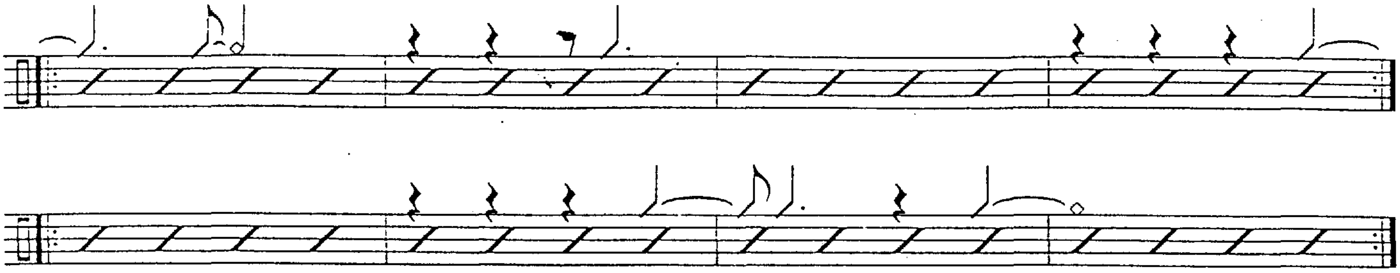
MCA/Impulse! MCAD 085

CD Track 15

"All Or Nothing At All" Comping

Macro Approach

In all of the examples and exercises up to this point, we have been looking at these concepts from a "micro" point of view. In other words, the material has been broken down into tiny bits; the left hand does this and the bass drum does that, etc., so the phrases are built up by connecting the tiny pieces. But this micro approach doesn't work when playing with people; you can't be thinking about what your limbs are doing. You must be hearing and relating to the big picture — *how does this music sound? how does this music feel?* It's time to consider a more "macro" phrasing approach. While playing page 21, use the rhythms written above the staff as "target points," like a pianist's comping, to add shape to your phrasing. As you repeat each phrase don't worry about how you are getting from point to point; the hi-hat does this and the ride cymbal does that, let your limbs follow their own natural flow. Focus on making the time feel good and the rhythmic structure apparent. The goal is to be able to play each phrase many different ways, stressing a different point in the architecture each time through. You will notice that, for the most part, these target points are placed to keep your ideas moving forward; the four-bar phrases don't resolve in a symmetrical fashion. You have to be able to feel the rhythms going across the bar lines and simultaneously to have a sure grip on your time so that you don't get confused and lose your place. You must develop the "strength" to make music with these phrases and not feel the need to mark the interior "ones," i.e., beat one of the second, third and fourth measures, or beat one of each four-bar idea. You can generate similar phrases of your own by "targeting" points of your choice from any song's melody.



Jack DeJohnette once explained his very sophisticated broken-time approach to me by using an analogy from a laundromat. He called his concept "washing machine time" and told me to visualize it like this; in a laundromat the washers and dryers have windows through which you can see the moving clothes. This motion is caused by the clothes being moved by the regular rotation of the machine's inner chamber, but the clothes never fall to the bottom of the chamber at the same point in the rotation. One time the clothes will be carried 1/4 of a revolution, then they will fall to the bottom. Another time they may travel 5/8s of the way around before they drop. Another time they could travel completely around without gravity pulling the clothes to the bottom. Jack told me that the fixed rate of the rotation of the machine, in real time (seconds), was analogous to the fixed duration of a musical phrase; i.e., one measure or four measures or eight measures, etc., and that he can feel "musical time" in terms of seconds — not just in terms of counting a certain number of beats per phrase. His ideas can fall anywhere in a phrase, just as the laundry can fall at any point in the machine's rotation, without disrupting the musical flow.

As I close this chapter, I hope you can see that one of the key evolutionary changes from the be-bop style is that the time playing function and the comping function have pretty much merged. The more or less "flat" time line, with comping accents, of bop has not been replaced by some *"new beat"* but by a rhythmically and dynamically undulating multi-voiced "pulse line." Post-bop drummers provided the pulse that the music thrived on and therefore became the emotional energy center of the ensemble, employing a wide variety of sonic and rhythmic ideas to create different textures and densities, thus dramatically affecting the mood of the music and the "color" of their ensemble's sound.

The era's prominent composers, John Coltrane, Wayne Shorter, Herbie Hancock, Ornette Coleman, Joe Henderson, McCoy Tyner and others, all wrote tunes that demanded that the players deal with new musical landscapes. Quite a number of their compositions are, to me, cinematic in nature and reminiscent of the music of the impressionistic classical composers Ravel and Debussy. In that regard, their compositions are one step further removed from the dance music that first made jazz popular. These jazz compositions paint pictures, they are mood pieces and, as such, require the use of a broad musical palette. The searing swing of Philly Joe Jones would be inappropriate for one of Wayne Shorter's haunting melodies. The free-wheeling nature of Ornette Coleman's music could be drained of its spirit by the "order" in Max Roach's approach.

Strong be-bop roots, along with expanded musical sensibilities, a sublime attunement to the music at hand and the willingness to "risk it all" in search of new musical milieus, are attributes shared by the best post-bop musicians.

become unstable and, of course, the music suffers.

The following exercises are designed to resolve these issues. I was introduced to this helpful material, in the 1970s while a student at the University of North Texas, by a fine player and teacher, the late Paul Guerrero. Paul told me that he worked on this kind of stuff with his teacher in the early 1960s, the late, great Shelly Manne. I continue to find playing through this kind of material beneficial.

Practice each line until you are executing it clearly, then work towards playing each page nonstop from beginning to end. Once you're no longer having difficulty with each page, use these exercises to increase your endurance — play all the pages nonstop. Keep the ride cymbal and hi-hat going as you turn the pages. Remember, as I explained in *The Art of Bop Drumming*, at speeds of ♩ = 140 or less, your ride pattern should be phrased in triplets. Between 140 and 150, depending on the tune's vibe, you will "flatten" out your pattern. Above 150, your ride pattern will sound best, and be most complementary to your bandmates' playing, when it is flatter — less triplety. Also keep in mind that your comping ideas must line up with your cymbal phrasing. Your goal should be to build your endurance so that you can play all pages, nonstop, at ♩ = 150+. Practice with the 32-measure loop, CD track 18.

On the technical side of things, relaxation and efficiency are essential. I play with my thumb up and use very little side to side arm motion. I have the best results while playing on one small area of the cymbal using a more or less straight up-and-down motion. My hand opens on beats 2 and 4 and closes on beats 1 and 3. I "throw" the stick on beats 2 and 4; i.e., my wrist drops and my fingers open. I let the stick rebound highly off the cymbal, on beats 2 and 4, without lifting my hand. To execute the skip note and beats 1 and 3, my fingers close to pull the stick back in. All my fingers are on the stick but my fulcrum is pretty loose. I use as much of the stick's natural rebound as possible, my cymbals are set up fairly low — so that my arms can "hang" from my shoulders — I'm not holding them up or out away from my body — and I maintain a relaxed, focused mindset.

...mekeeping, but we have become more aware of the possibilities of the drum set."

— Elvin Jones

Uptempo Studies

Elvin Jones

You can also go through the previous material playing the hi-hat on all 4 beats a la Tony Williams.

There is no trick or magic involved in competently playing uptempos or, for that matter, any type of music. Repetitive, consistent work brings positive results. I remember playing a tune called "Caldonia" with Woody Herman's band. "Caldonia" was our uptempo flag waver closing number. The tune was a 12-bar blues and the format, after Woody sang the head, was: 4 sax solos, 2 trombone solos, 4 trumpet solos, piano solo, bass solo and finally a drum solo during which the band would leave the stage. Some of the guys in the trumpet section had stop watches and would time the length of each chorus during the sax solos, all the while encouraging the rhythm section to make the tempo faster than the previous night's. We seemed to settle into 6-second choruses at ♩ = 400!! Needless to say, playing that fast through 12 solos will cause fatigue and make you look for ways to rest while you continue to burn it out.

CD 18 Track

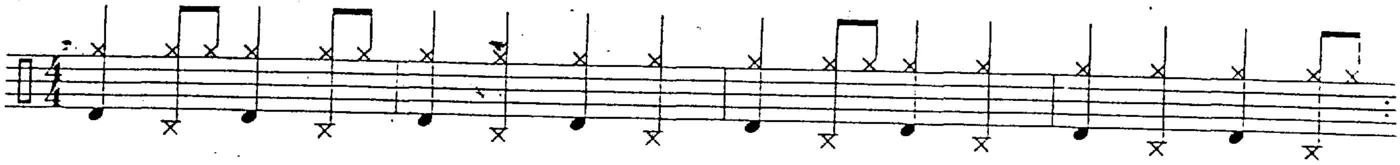
Bass loop — 8 choruses of 32-bar A-A-B-A "rhythm" changes to play along with (♩ = 150).


Tony Williams
mplied Time,
Metric Modulation

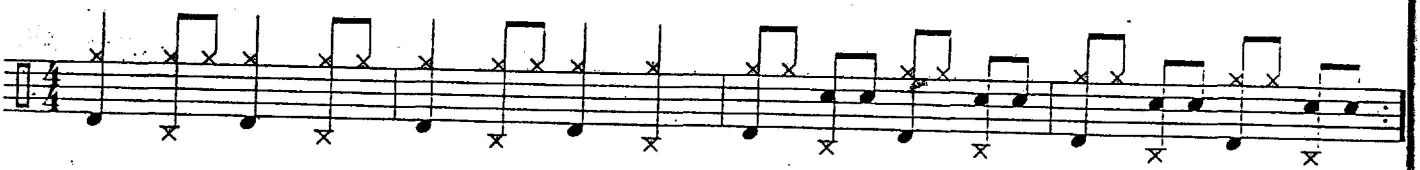
As I mentioned in Chapter 1, in the '60s jazz rhythm sections became more adventurous and aggressive. Two of the leading rhythm sections of the day, and of all time, were John Coltrane's, with McCoy Tyner (piano), Jimmy Garrison (bass) and Elvin Jones (drums), and Miles Davis', with Herbie Hancock (piano), Ron Carter (bass) and Tony Williams (drums). These two rhythm sections were great at supporting, accompanying and stimulating their soloists by creating a different feeling or mood for each soloist on each tune. At times they would "shift gears" within a solo to take the music to a new level of intensity. This shifting of gears also pushed the music into new directions. These intensity surges were accomplished by superimposing a new time feeling or some unusual rhythmic groupings over the original time feel. The most frequently used devices involved going directly into double-time or into a double-time feel — the chord changes continue at the original rate while the rhythm section plays twice as fast. The rhythm section could also change the music's intensity by shifting to half-time or into a half-time feel — the harmony continues at the original rate while the rhythm section plays half as fast.

Occasionally these great rhythm sections would really capture the imaginations of the other musicians and their audience by creating the impression of a sudden shift into a completely new tempo, not double- or half-time, but totally unrelated to the original tempo. In reality, these wild shifts in tempo are not unrelated at all, but are based on a number of logical superimpositions.

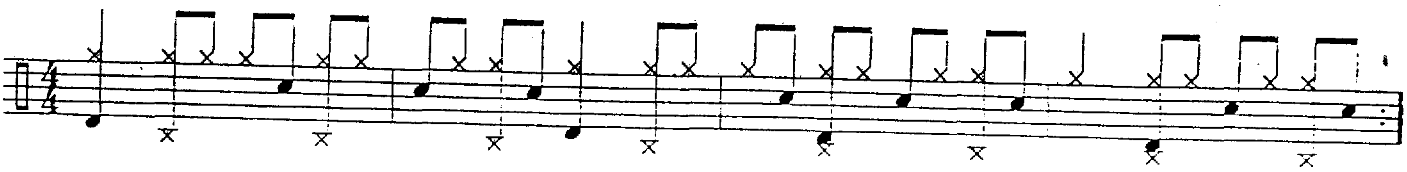
Here are some exercises that will show you how to understand, recognize and develop these different time shifting devices. Mastering this material will help you improve your time and expand your vocabulary.



Next, intersperse double-strokes, hand to hand à la Max Roach, with the regular pattern. On paper this exercise looks somewhat strange, but when used sparingly it sounds fine and provides some rest:

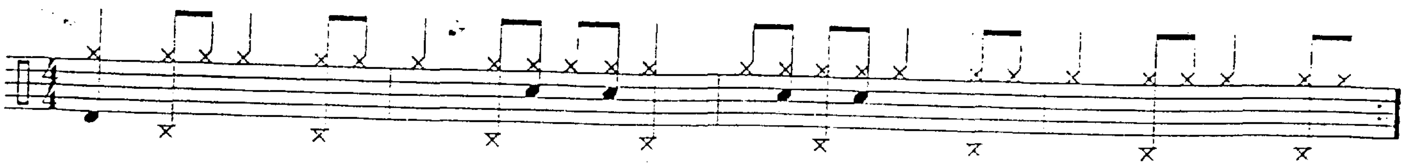


Third, break up your cymbal pattern the way Mel Lewis did at uptempos:

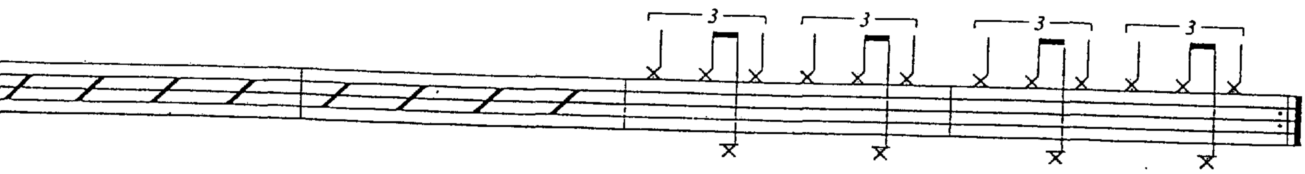


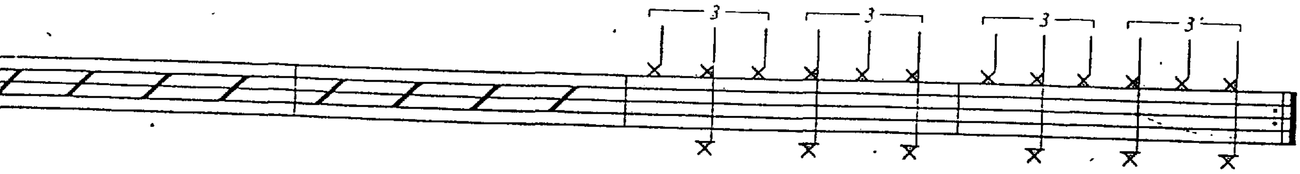
Fourth, here is a device, based on the paradiddle-diddle sticking, that Elvin Jones uses for variety at all tempos:

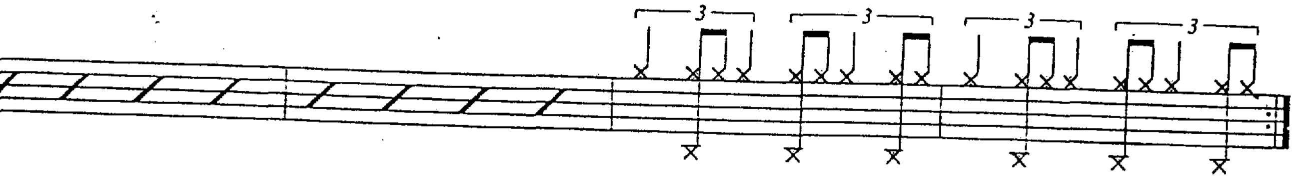
Finally, here is a type of uptempo cymbal phrasing that Tony Williams uses. Tony's great technique allows him to play this five-note pattern, which actually increases the load on your ride hand. Use this phrasing to add variety, but don't expect any rest. The notes on the snare drum help "goose" the ride cymbal along:



...time shifting devices is superimposed quarter-note triplets, also known as the "6 over 4" feel, which gives the impression of surging ahead. Keep the original tempo in mind and develop it this way:





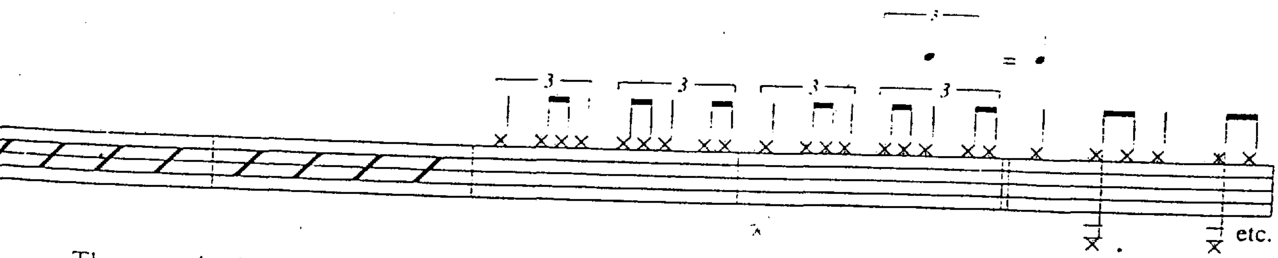


Devices of this kind can be used in several ways:

❑ For a few bars as a short increase in tension;

❑ For a chorus or more where the harmony continues it's original rate; or

❑ As a shift to a specific new tempo; i.e.:

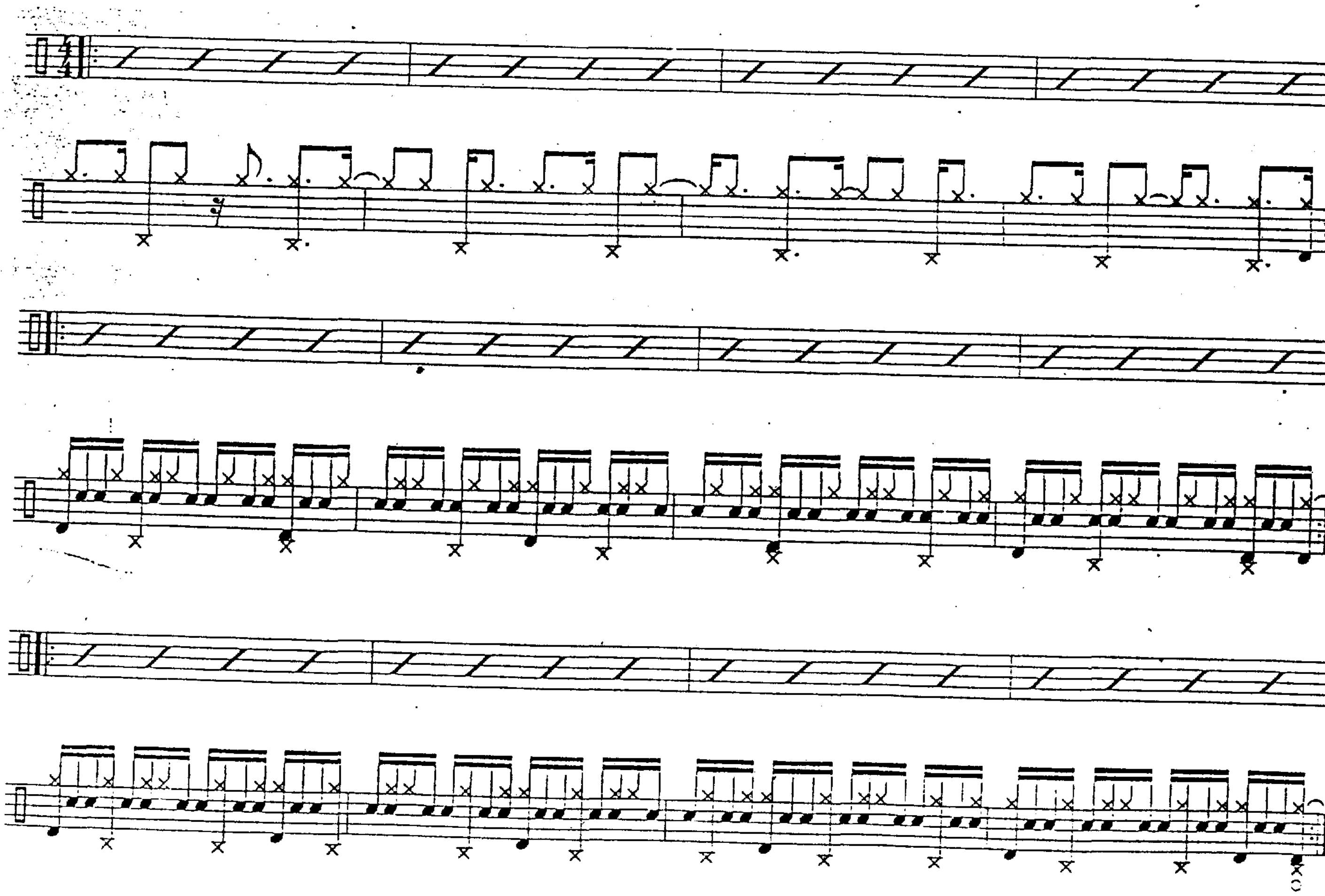


The example above shows how a metric modulation can take place: the note triplet rate becomes the new quarter-note pulse.

CD 24 Track

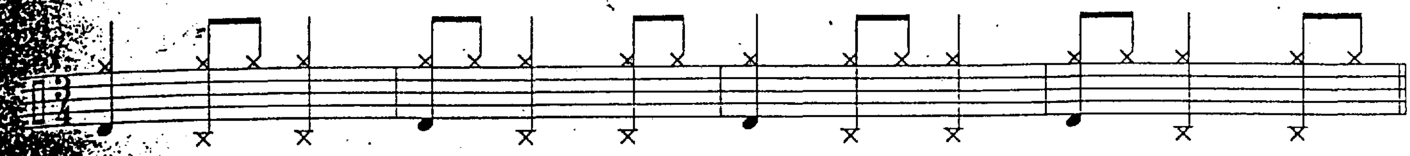
4 over 3 in 4/4

At slower tempos, Roy Haynes, Elvin Jones, and Tony Williams might play rhythms based on dotted eighth-notes to create motion and a faster feeling. Remember the original tempo because you will want to be able to return to it.

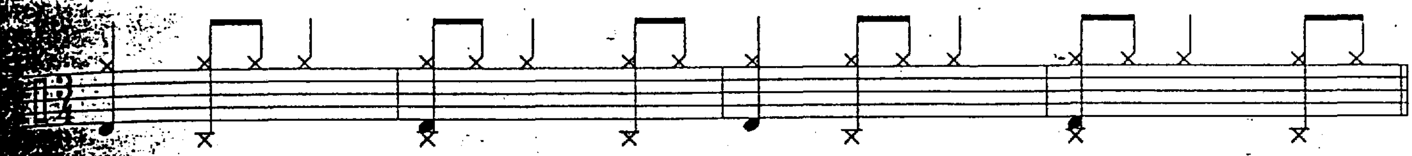


Once you are comfortable with any of the previous ideas in 4/4, try applying them as you play along with CD track 39 "The El Trane" (slow version).

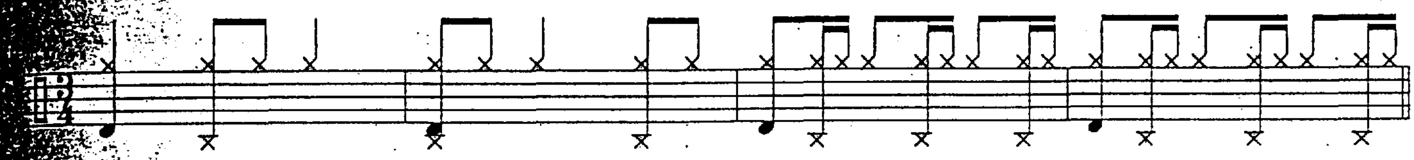
The ride cymbal implies 4/4.



Ride cymbal and hi-hat imply 4/4.

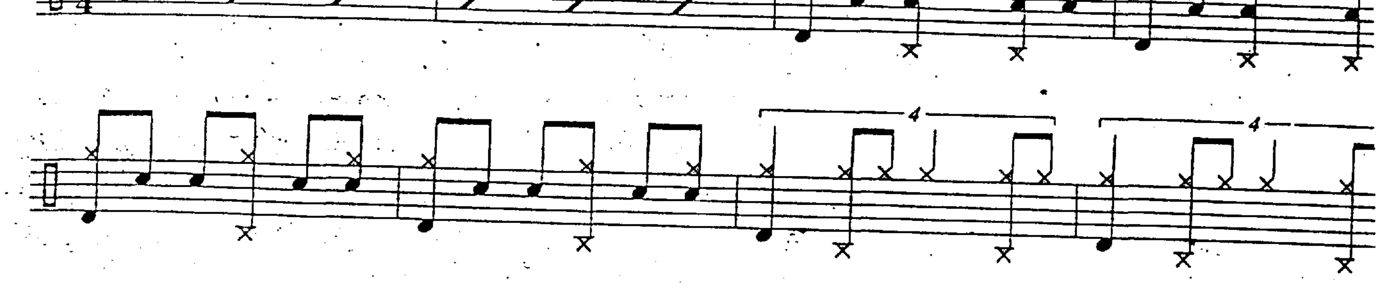


Ride cymbal and hi-hat imply 4/4 then a double-time feel.



2 over 3

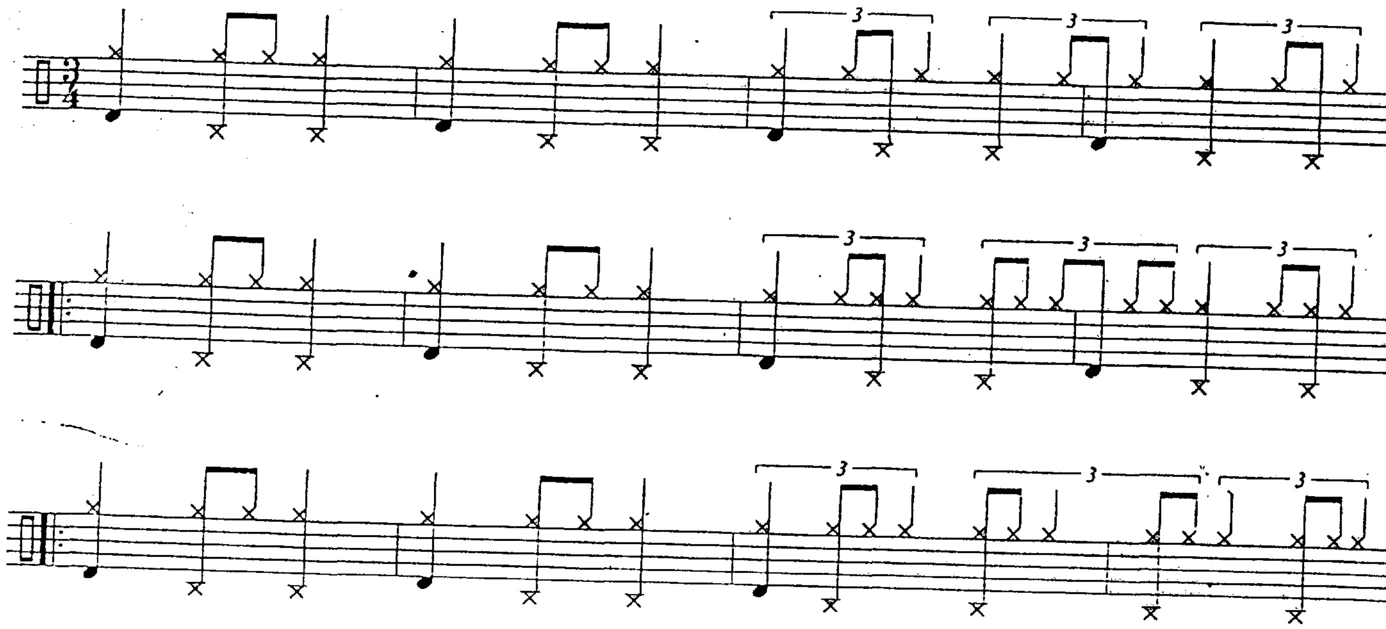
Now, some dotted-quarter note based rhythms in 3/4. These give the impression of the time slowing down:



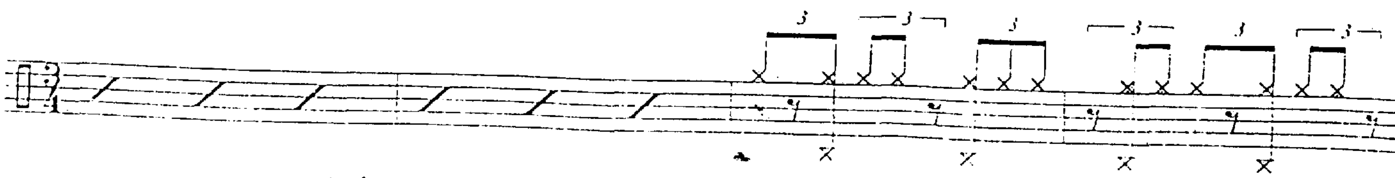
CD 27 Track

9 over 6 in 3/4

Here is a very deceptive superimposition; quarter-note triplet based rhythms in 3/4. These ideas take two measures to resolve:



The previous example can be notated like this:



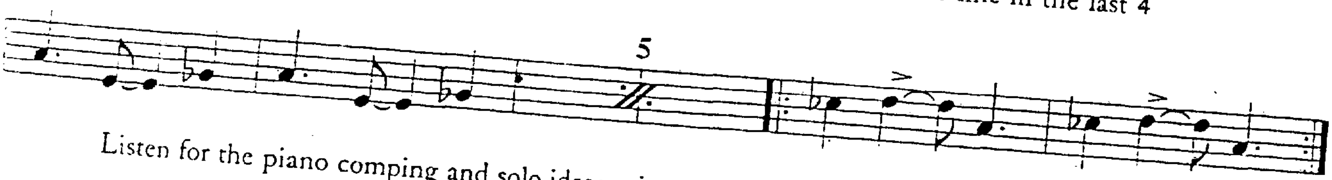
Basic Germs:

is a rawness, a feeling of urgency, in Elvin's and Tony's spontaneous use of these time shifting concepts that comes, in my opinion, from the organic nature of their development and deployment. To me, the feeling of their music is analogous to the feeling of taking a roller coaster ride in the dark. "New math" wasn't their priority; new expression was the only objective. The passion of their group's music, not their individual egos, directed these explorations. That being said, musicians inspired by those bands have refined some of these permutations and cleaned up the "math." In the process, they may have diluted some of that urgency but they make the rhythms clearer and easier to grasp; a little bit like that same roller coaster ride in broad daylight. One CD in particular, Wynton Marsalis' *Standard Time Vol.1*, provides good music, excellent sound quality and a number of highly refined, musically satisfying and clearly played time shifting devices. Get this CD and check out how these ideas can be used in a musical context.

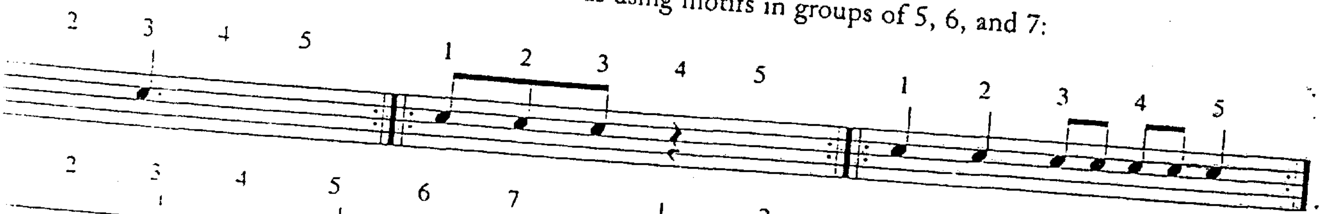
Columbia CK 40461

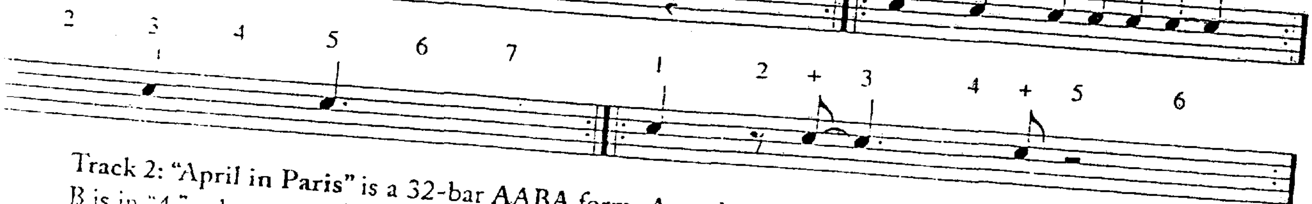
Following is an analysis of some of the rhythmic concepts used on *Standard Time Vol. 1* and indications on how they correspond with the material in this chapter. It's important that you recognize how comfortably and fluently all of the players in the group are tossing these complicated ideas around, not just drummer par excellence Jeff Watts.

Track 1: "Caravan" is a 64-bar AABA form, A sections played with "second line/safari" groove, B is in "4." Listen for the tension created by the displaced bass line in the last 4 bars of the A sections:

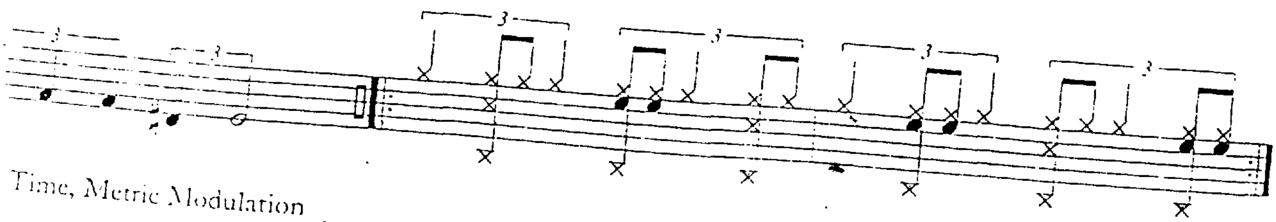


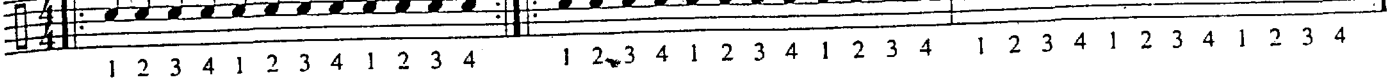
Listen for the piano comping and solo ideas using motifs in groups of 5, 6, and 7:



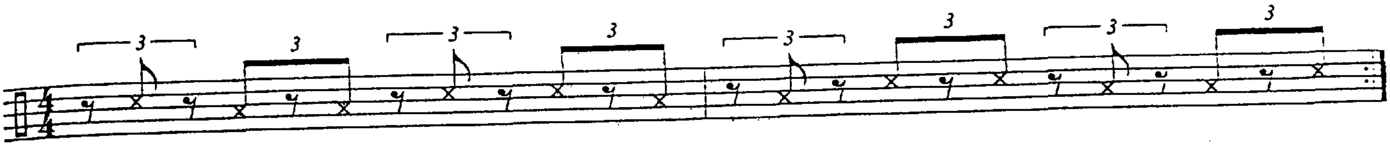


Track 2: **"April in Paris"** is a 32-bar AABA form, A sections played with "6 over 4" feel, B is in "4," solos are in "4." Listen for the count-off "1 2 3 4" to get the real tempo. To develop this type of phrasing, work on page 33.

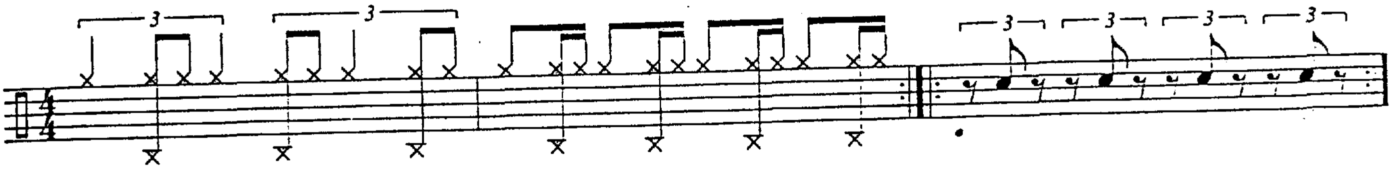




Listen for the displaced triplets at the end of Marcus' solo:

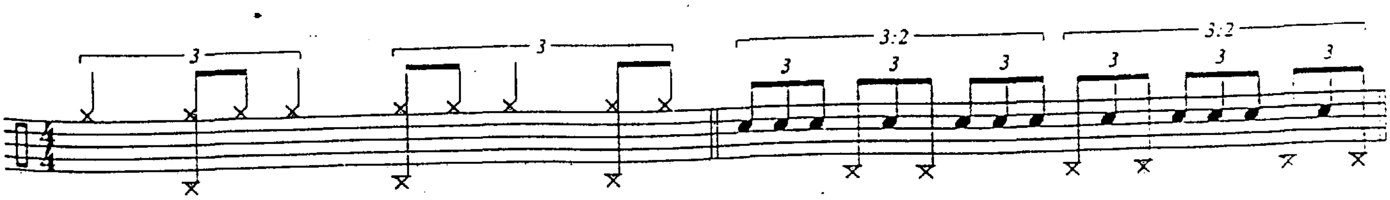


Check out the mix of 6 over 4, double time and accented middle triplet note ideas Jeff plays during the closing melody:



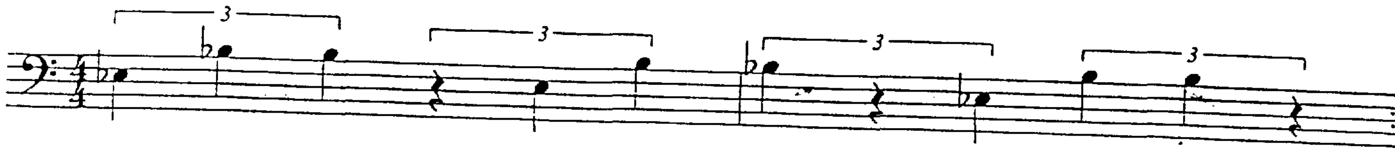
Tracks 3 and 12: "Cherokee" is a 64-bar **AABA** form. Listen to how the trumpet phrases the melody in groups of 7 while the piano toys with the melody, playing it at times one beat early and then one beat late:

Track 7: "A Foggy Day" is a 32-bar 16 + 16 form. During the intro, listen for Jeff using "6 over 4" and "9 over 2" devices against the flow. The head is in "2":



1 2 3 4 5 1 2 3 4 5 1 2 3 4 5

Listen to how the bass changes the flow by playing quarter-note triplets in groups of 4 during the tag:



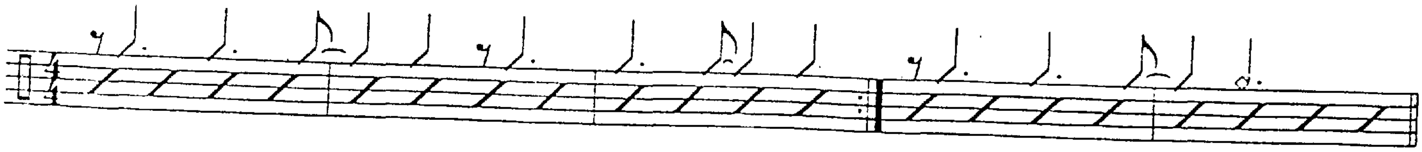
Track 8: "The Song is You" has a 6-bar intro, 64-bar **AABA** form. Listen to the four-bar count-off setting the real tempo. The "slow motion" feel is based on the dotted quarter-note pulse, as on page 35. The rhythm section plays the intro like this:

INTRO

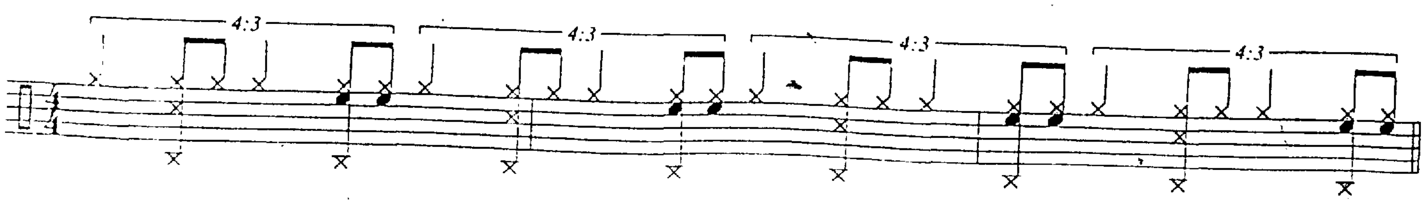
A

Jeff interprets it like this:

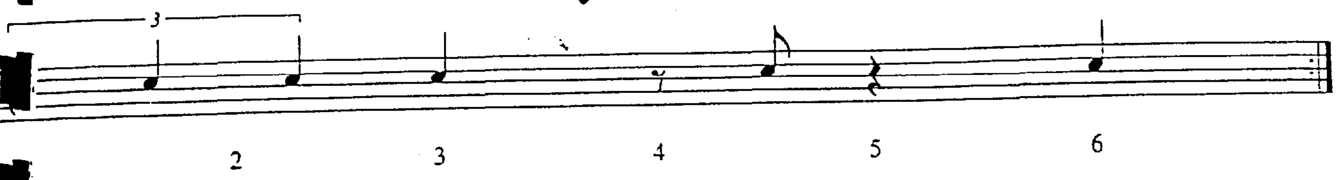
The second and last **A** sections are a little different; the bridge is in "4." These **A** sections start like this:



Jeff doubles up the phrase and plays it like this:



out the piano comping behind Wynton. Here's a six-beat phrase Marcus uses:



Track 11: **"Autumn Leaves"** is a 32-bar **AABA** form. Listen to the rhythm section's "measured" accelerando during the first two A sections, the bridge in "4" and the "measured" ritardando in the last A:

Listen for the up-beat motifs, "5s" and "7s" during the piano solo:

Here are a few of the three-beat comping ideas Marcus uses throughout this 4/4 track:

Other good recorded examples of this type of metric material can be found in the music of Charles Mingus, in particular *Mingus Presents Charles Mingus*, and in the music of Dave Holland on the recordings *Seeds of Time* and *Extensions* with drummer Marvin "Smitty" Smith.

out the piano comping behind Wynton. Here's a six-beat phrase Marcus uses:

Track 11: "Autumn Leaves" is a 32-bar **AABA** form. Listen to the rhythm section's "measured" accelerando during the first two **A** sections, the bridge in "4" and the "measured" ritardando in the last **A**:

Listen for the up-beat motifs, "5s" and "7s" during the piano solo:

Here are a few of the three-beat comping ideas Marcus uses throughout this 4/4 track:

Other good recorded examples of this type of metric material can be found in the music of Charles Mingus, in particular *Mingus Presents Charles Mingus*, and in the music of Dave Holland on the recordings *Seeds of Time* and *Extensions* with drummer Marvin "Smitty" Smith.

*dialogues with yourself as we…
the soloist.' I had never though…
that way, but it's true. If you t…
everything else and just list…
what I was playing, you'd …
complete composition."*

—Jack DeJ…

Solo Ideas

Just as the parameters of time playing expanded in the post bop era, so did the drummer's solo vocabulary and soloing opportunities. Drum solos were often on the form of the song, as in be-bop, but frequently, like the leading horn players of the day, the drummer's vocabulary and phrasing intentionally disguised the underlying song structure. This camouflage was created by developing phrases that resolve in places other than the song's major resolution points. A second common soloing approach was to play a solo based on the song's "vibe," or emotional message, not on the structure of the composition. This second type of soloing is more like *spontaneous composition* in the mood of a given piece of music and may or may not be played "in time."

As children we quickly learn simple songs through repetition. We learn to anticipate where a particular melodic phrase is going by feeling the up-coming resolution point and "singing to it." These resolution points exert the musical equivalent of gravitational or magnetic pull. When a song doesn't go the way in which we expect it to go we become confused and take longer to learn it. In classical music the name for a phrase that is leading in one direction but takes a sudden "left" is a *deceptive cadence*. This device eliminates the feeling of rest or resolution at the point where you expect a pause, thereby pushing the music onward. Melodically, harmonically and rhythmically the music of the '60s is rich with deceptive cadences, and the post bop drummers, both in their time playing and soloing, were experts at playing in a way that propelled the music forward.

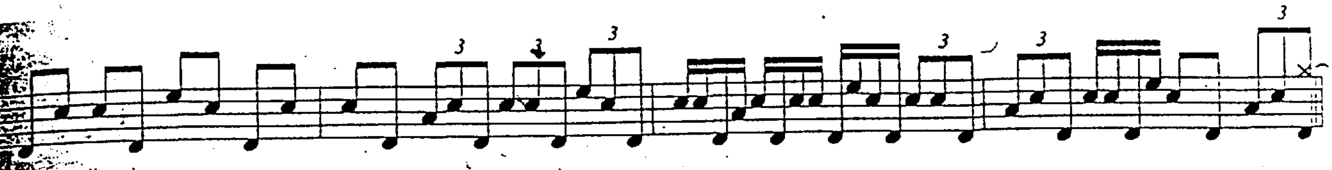
One of the most important skills you must develop in order to understand and feel this music is the ability to feel phrases that evolve over the course of several measures and don't necessarily finish on a "1" when you expect them to. The deceptive cadences which be-bop musicians created were usually built by using ideas that were three beats long to throw the music's symmetry off. Post bop musicians often played considerably longer phrases without landing on beat "1."

In this chapter we'll explore how the various solo phrasing concepts that evolved from be-bop techniques were expanded, refined and utilized by the post Bop innovators. These techniques include playing long phrases across the bar line phrases and using odd groupings to create mystery — deceptive cadences. We'll examine transcriptions of solos played in the three most common formats drummers face: a *32-bar tune* by Elvin Jones, in a *free form* setting by Tony Williams and over a *vamp* by the under-appreciated Bob Moses. We'll also work on achieving greater fluidity around the drumset.

If you are comfortable with be-bop vocabulary, which I urge you to thoroughly check out before getting into this material, then you can feel four- and eight-bar phrases without any trouble. Let's begin building on that foundation by exploring some three-beat phrases that create mystery by extending across several bar lines. Play the hi-hat on 2 and 4 unless indicated otherwise.

The Three-beat Phrase with Rests —

Now change the pace of the phrase by adding rests. Notice that the basic germ creates the "hook" (continuity and familiarity) while the rests create tension and mystery:



Triplets in Groups of Four

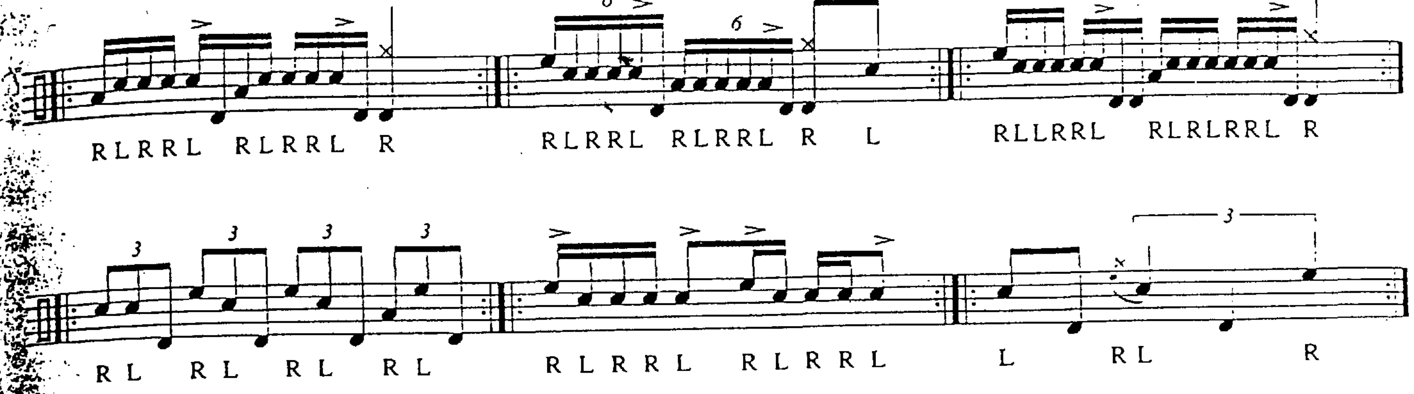
Interesting ideas can be built based on triplets phrased in groups of four. This type of phrasing creates the illusion of a shift in pulse and is used extensively by Tony Williams and Bob Moses:

unless indicated otherwise.

Now let's examine three great solos to see how the previously described material can be used in a musical context. Get these recordings — hear the masters play!

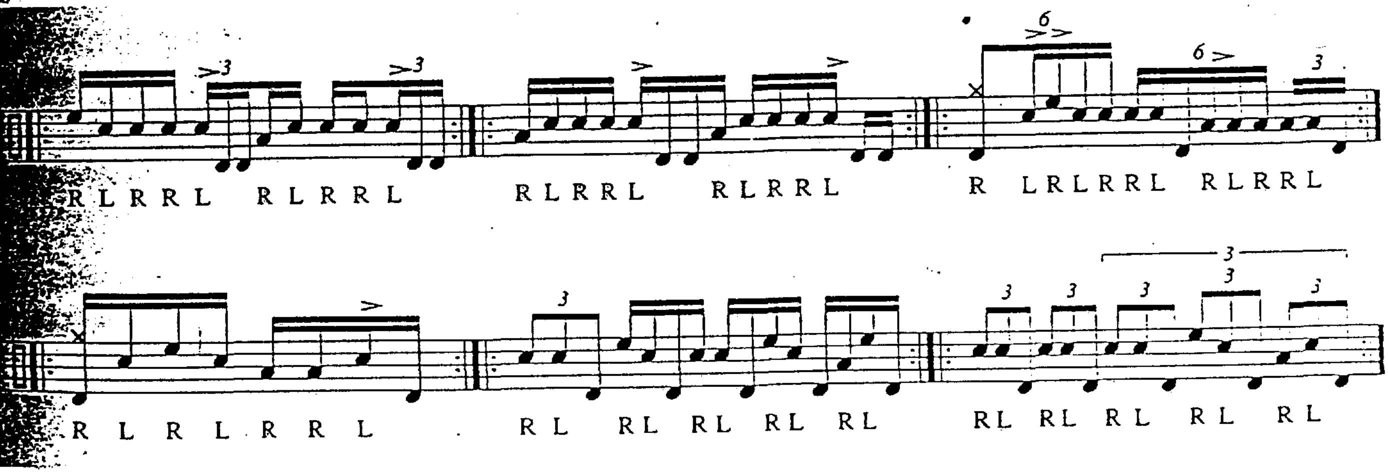
- ❑ Elvin plays a standard 4-piece drum kit with two cymbals and hi-hat.
- ❑ The unaccompanied drum solo is on the form and follows a long organ solo.
- ❑ The solo is basically through-composed and bears little resemblance to the melody.
- ❑ The beginning of each eight-bar phrase is obscured by across-the-bar phrases; however, the texture changes in the vicinity of the beginning of each eight-bar phrase.
- ❑ Rhythmic density, dynamics and intensity level are consistent throughout.
- ❑ Nice mix of 8ths, 8th-note triplets, 16ths and 16th-note triplets.
- ❑ Elvin uses three-beat phrases extensively.
- ❑ Use of familiar vocabulary which is organized and executed in a very personal way.

Blue Note BST-84221

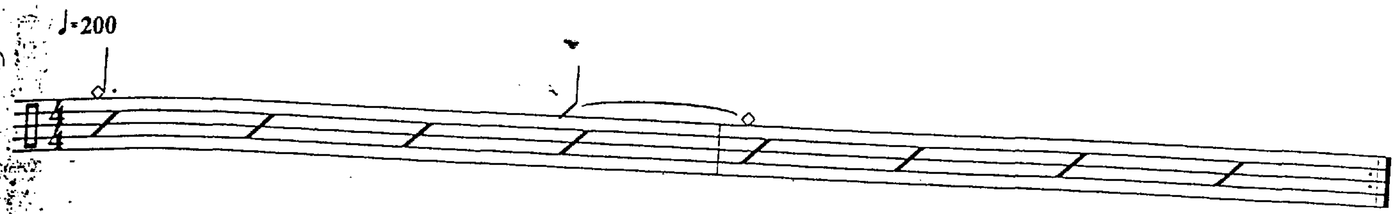


Variations

Here are some combinations and variations, based on this Elvin solo, to work through.

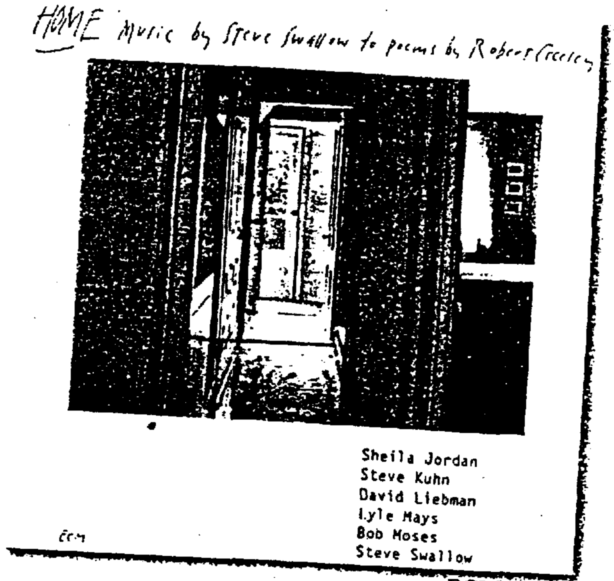


Elvin's highly personal phrasing leads many musicians to think that, when soloing, he is playing out of time and that this "Monk's Dream" solo is a free form solo. As you can see and hear, this solo is definitely in time and on the form; however, the extensive use of deceptive cadences and across-the-bar phrases really do camouflage the tune's structure.



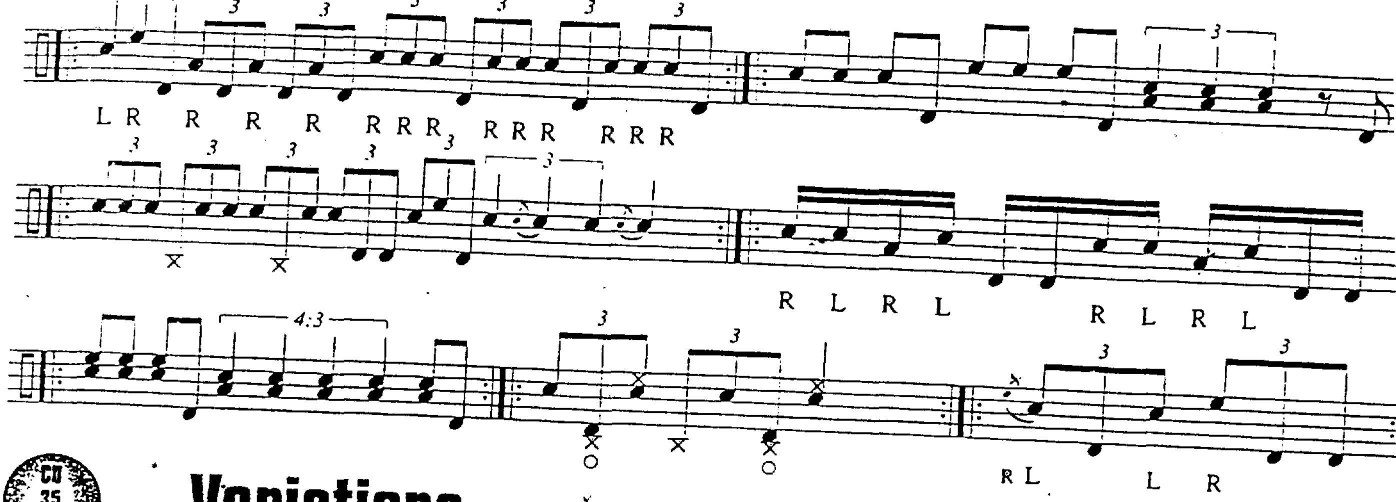
The particulars:

- ❑ Bob plays a five-piece drum kit with two cymbals and hi-hat.
- ❑ The main resolution points are avoided, except at the top of the fifth chorus.
- ❑ Extensive use of theme and variation phrasing.
- ❑ Sound and vocabulary reminiscent of Roy Haynes but highly refined, developed and expanded by Moses.
- ❑ Most 8th-notes are played straight.
- ❑ Good use of space, silence.
- ❑ Bob avoids playing in unison with the vamp. His ideas go against the ostinato similar to the way latin soloists play against the clave.
- ❑ Phrases tend to dissolve rather than resolve, leaving the listener wanting more.
- ❑ Extensive use of the bass drum as a third hand.
- ❑ Fluid shifts from 8ths, to 8th-note triplets, to 16ths.
- ❑ Interesting use of the hi-hat as both a third hand and crash cymbal.
- ❑ Bob uses a small vocabulary to create continuity but fully develops each idea to create intrigue.
- ❑ Nice sound and touch on the instrument.
- ❑ Solo complements the turbulent harmonic feeling.



ECM 1-1160

> *"I start with a definite theme, which is not abandoned. It's played with, messed with, cut up and collaged, inverted and stretched, but it comes back. It's never gone until I make the choice to break the theme and begin a new one. It's all question and answer and definite thematic material."*
>
> — Bob Moses

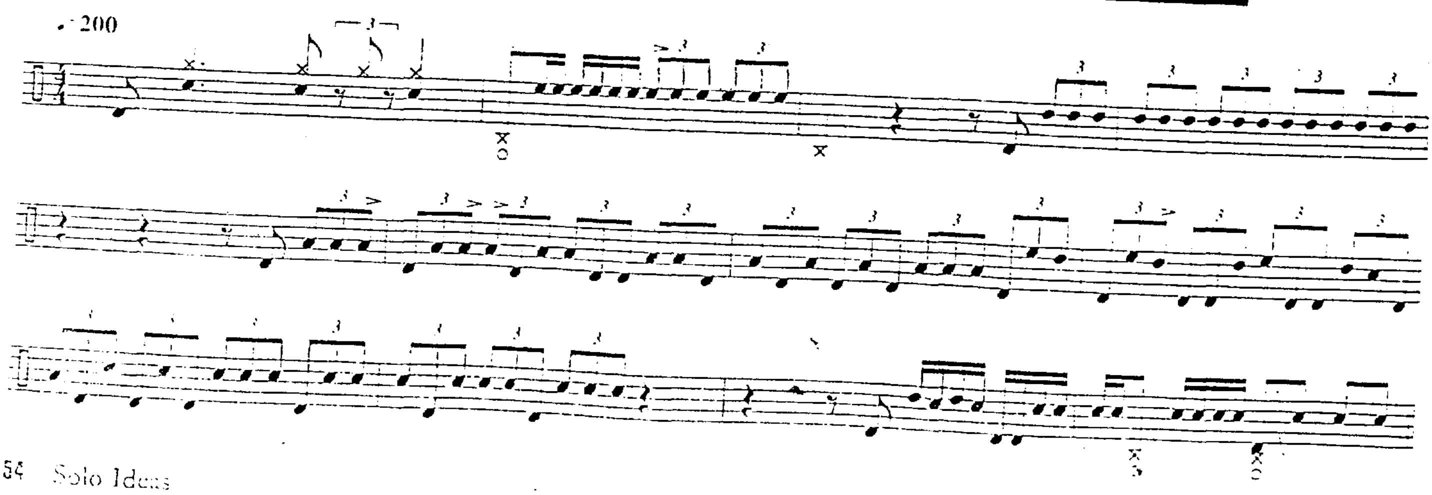


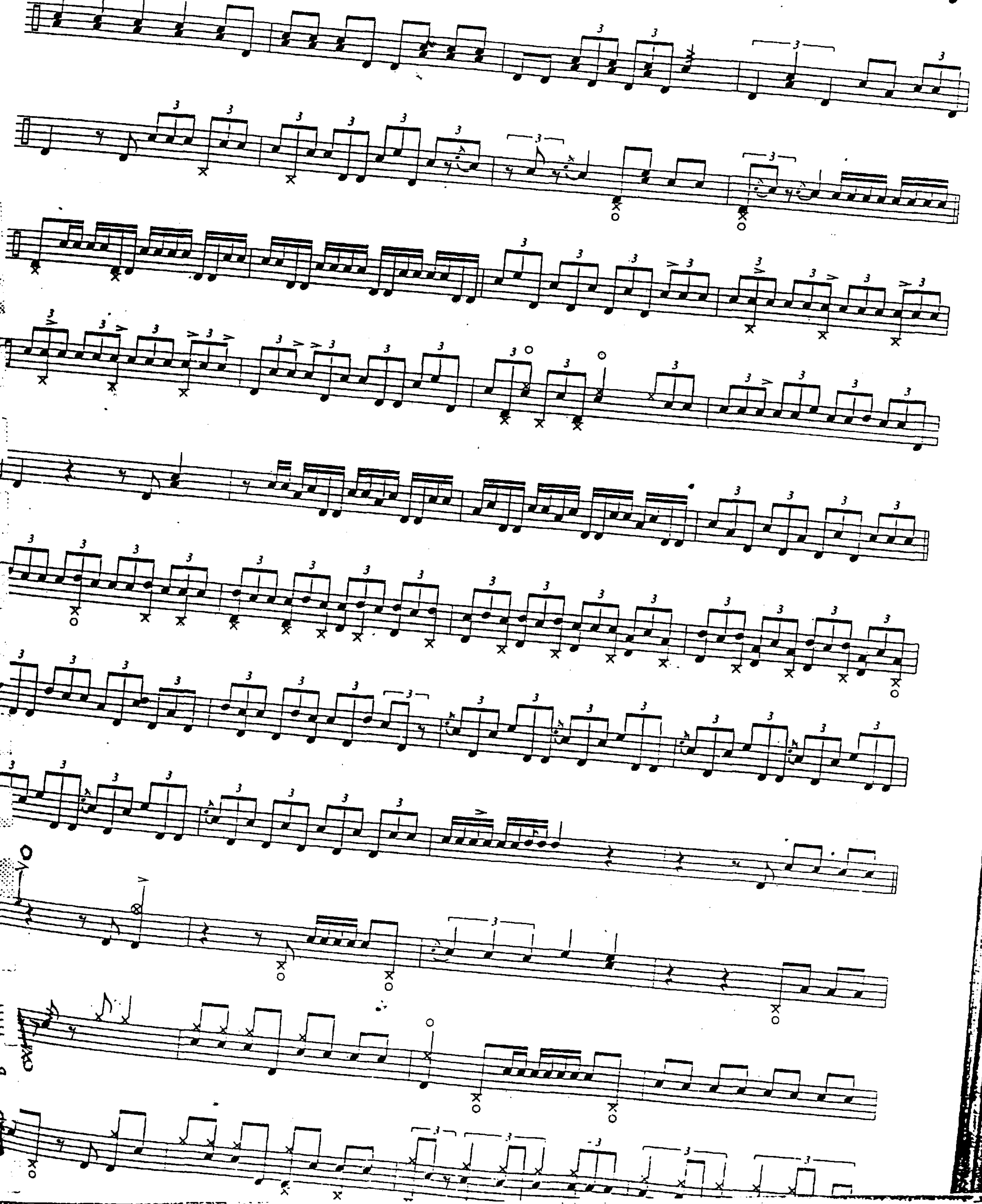
CD 35 Track

Variations

Here are some variations, derived from Bob's ideas, to work on:

"In the Fall"

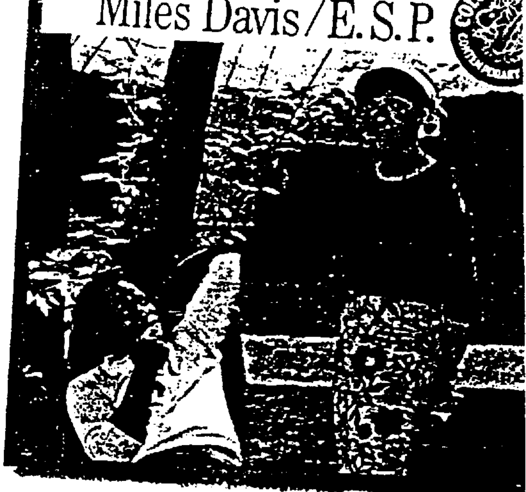




recorded in January, 1965.

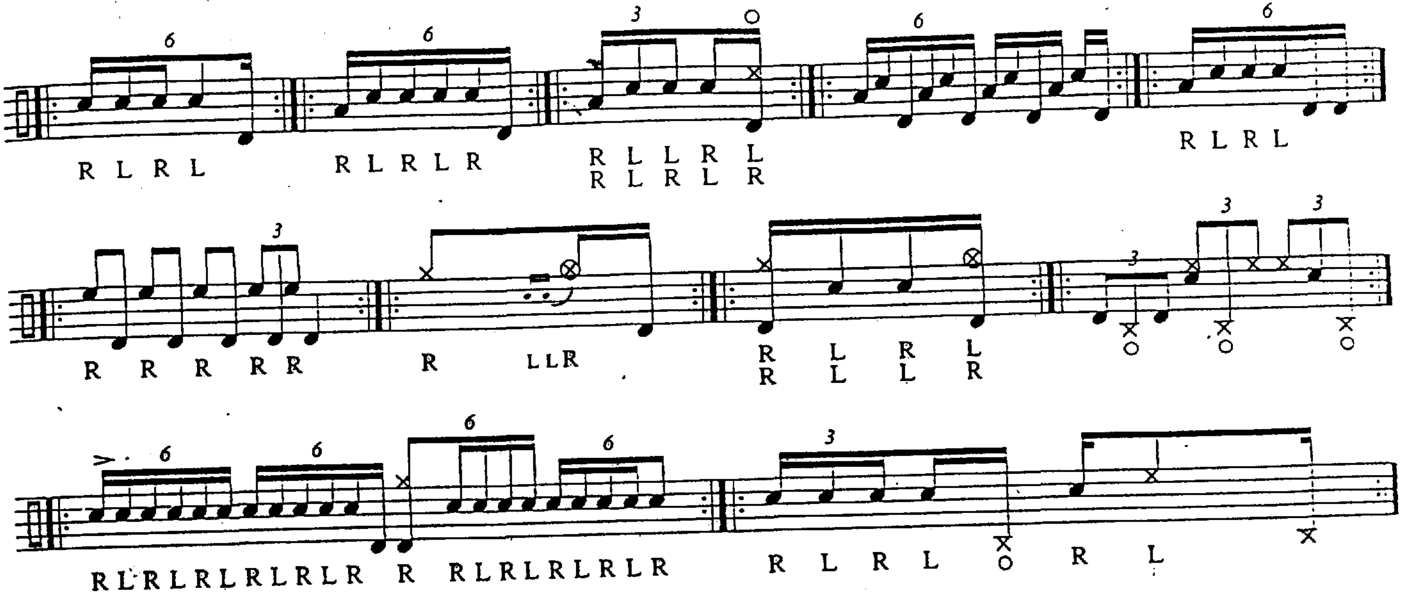
The particulars:

- ❑ Tony plays a standard four-piece drum kit with 2 cymbals and hi-hat.
- ❑ The solo is out of time and on no specific structure; however, it captures the mood of the title very well.
- ❑ Long dense phrases, often built on snare and bass drum combinations.
- ❑ The bass drum is employed extensively as a third hand.



Columbia CK-4686

- ❑ Cymbals are used for accents, but not exclusively to begin or end phrases.
- ❑ Liberal use of double and multiple bounce strokes, most often played by the left hand on the snare drum as "fill-ins."
- ❑ Exceptional technical command and fluidity around the set.
- ❑ Wide dynamic and textural range.
- ❑ Use of various types of touch, including playing into the drum creating "dead strokes."
- ❑ Use of hi-hat as a crash cymbal.
- ❑ Very little obvious bop vocabulary present.
- ❑ Solo was probably edited onto this take.

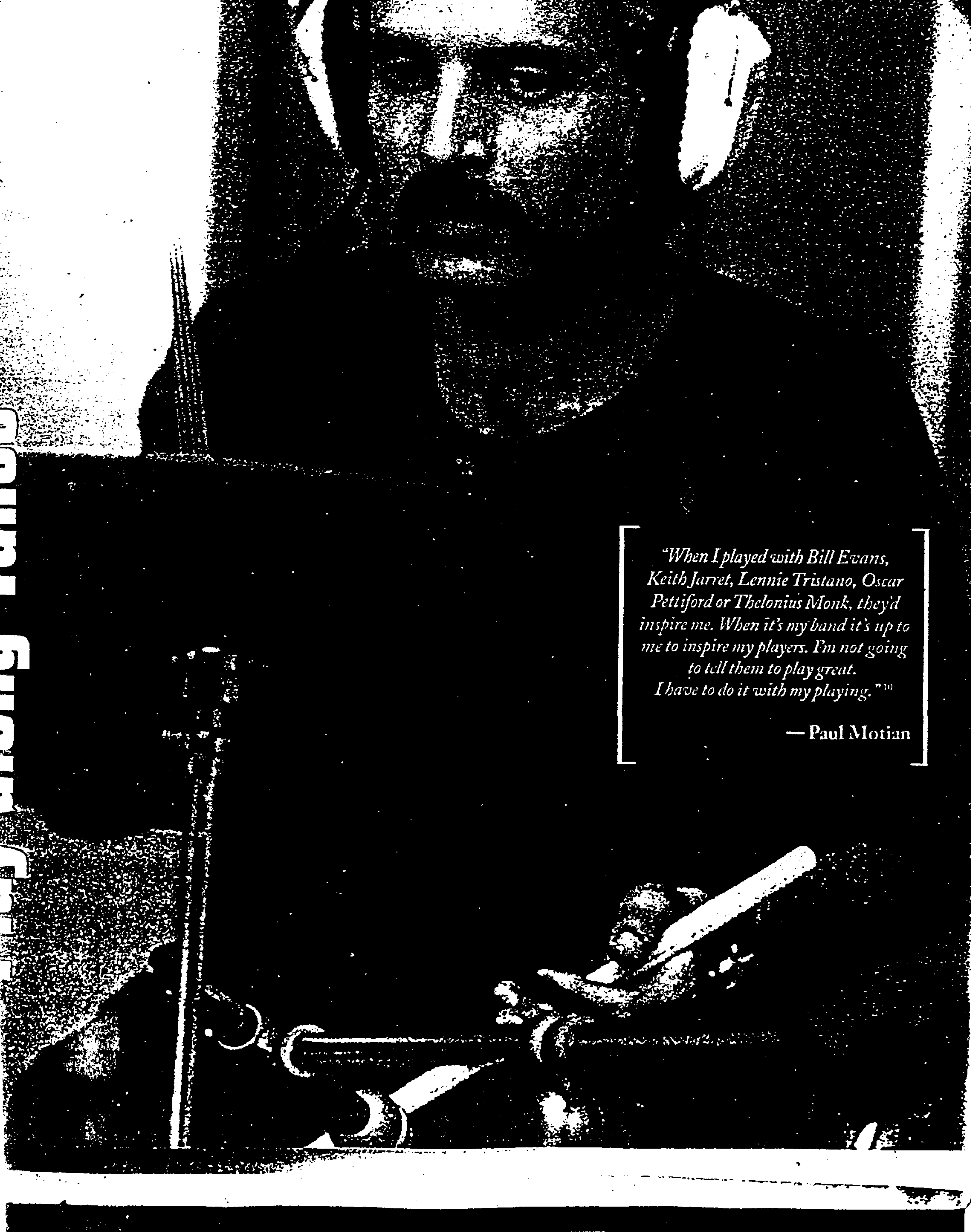


Variations

Here are some variations, inspired by Tony's solo ideas, to work on:

While I've broken these solos into fragments for easy digestion, stringing licks together is not what soloing is all about. There must be both an underlying logical structure and a sense of story telling to your solos in order for them to be musically satisfying. Hopefully, studying these solos will inspire you to explore all the musical possibilities of the drumset.


p
mp
ff
mf
staggered
p
faster
mf
f
= 140


"When I played with Bill Evans, Keith Jarret, Lennie Tristano, Oscar Pettiford or Thelonius Monk, they'd inspire me. When it's my band it's up to me to inspire my players. I'm not going to tell them to play great. I have to do it with my playing." [10]
— Paul Motian

with it and it flows. Then work toward... using hand-to-hand sticking — don't use any double strokes, make the "crosses" smooth.

Any of these ideas can also be played at a 16th-note rate to create phrases that are 3 beats long such as:

are two different takes of this tune, each with specific requirements from the drummer. The first take has a slower, "rolling" triplet feel. As you play with this track, focus on locking up with Jay Anderson's bass lines. Once you are comfortable with the tempo and feel, you can begin paying attention to Jim's piano comps and playing off the soloists. This is a good tempo at which to try some of the "three-voice comping" ideas that we discussed in the first chapter. This tempo is also good for working out the implied time ideas from Chapter Three. The second and faster take of "The El Trane" shifts between a broken latin feel and a 4/4 swing. The latin groove, which I start out with, is transcribed for you — be sure to swing the eighth-notes. Jay plays a lot of anticipations in this section so don't be thrown off. Jim plays some downbeats for you to latch onto. Be sure to check out the format for each tune before you start playing along. Remember, use this CD and other recordings to work out your ideas rather than practicing them on the bandstand.

"Speed Bumps Ahead"

The second play-along tune, "Speed Bumps Ahead," was inspired by two of my favorite modern jazz composers, John Scofield and Jim McNeely. I recommend playing straight time the first few times through the "speed bumps" section at letter B. This will help you hear and feel how this unusual phrase works. After the solos, play the A section of the head twice and go to the coda. The coda includes a drum solo section that is an expanded variation on the B section. CD track 42 is the drum solo section played twice through for play-along.

"Blind Faith"

The final play-along piece is called "Blind Faith" and was inspired by the playing of Miles Davis' great 1960s quintet with Tony Williams. This tune is a freewheeling uptempo piece that serves as a vehicle for improvisation. As with the other play-along tunes, your first objective is to focus on playing with the bass player. Since there is no set form, or tempo, you must really hear the direction which the other musicians are taking, and try to contribute to the overall flow of their ideas. After Tim's sax solo, there is a short drum solo section with some odd phrase lengths. CD track 44 isolates the drum solo section, so that you can become more familiar with it.

In order to grow as a player, you must push yourself to play in new ways. Each of these play-along tunes can be approached and treated in many different ways; aggressively, calmly, straight-ahead or broken-up; with sticks, brushes or mallets. Experiment while playing with these tracks and, if possible, record yourself playing along. That way it will be easier to assess exactly how your playing is growing and what you need to work on.

Slow

Format:

Melody 1x

Sax solo 1 chorus

Piano solo 1 chorus

Out head 1x

Vamp ending

Fast

Format:

Four-bar Intro

Melody 1x, A's Latinish, B's swing

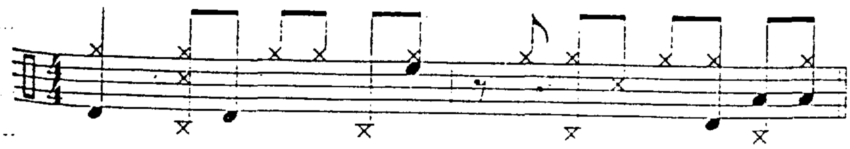
Sax solo 2 choruses

Piano solo 2 choruses

Out head 1x

Vamp and fade

Latin Groove




Bm7
A♭7/G
D♭m
B♭7/D
E♭m7
C7/E
Fm7
1.
E♭7/G
2.
to Coda
G2/B
B
F2/A
E♭2/G
A♭2/C
G2/B
F2/A
E♭2/G
A♭2/C
G2/B
F2/A
E♭2/G
E♭7
C
Solos
A♭m7
A♭7/C
D♭m7
B♭7/D
E♭m7
C7/E
Fm7

ormat:

-bar drum intro

ne head with pickups [A] [A] [B]

iano solo 2 choruses |: [C] and [D] :|

ax solo 2 choruses |: [C] and [D] :|

D.C. for melody (2 [A] sections)

To Coda for drum solo and ending

[E] is highlighted in grey and played twice through on CD Track 42 for you to practice with.


A
Drum fill
Drum fill
2
2
to Coda


B Piano and tenor solos "free," to end solo cue C
C
After tenor solo and C play D for drum solo
D
D.S. al Coda
Coda
fine